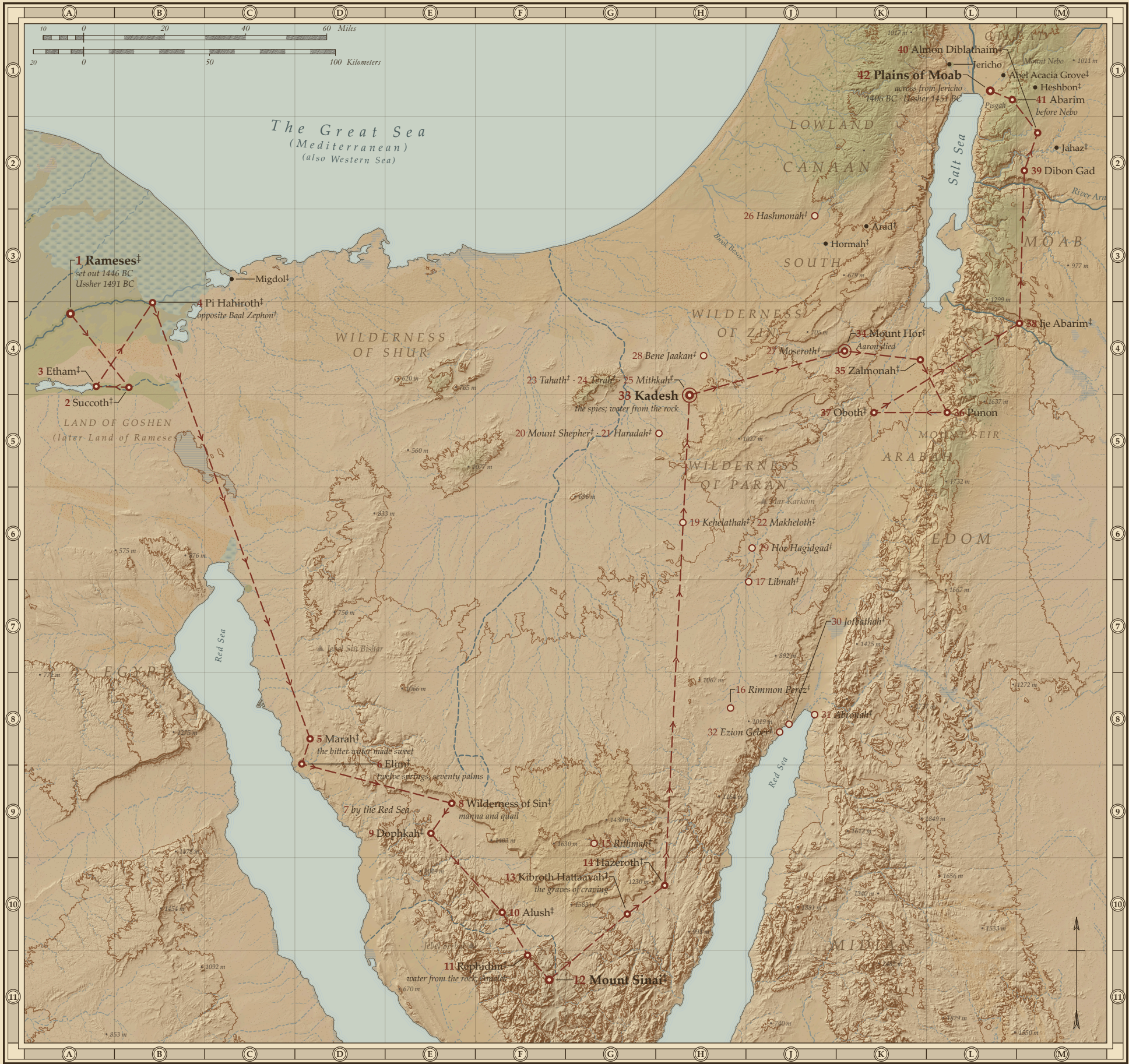




THE ROUTE OF THE EXODUS

The stages of the journey, Rameses to the plains of Moab · Numbers 33 · 1446–1406 BC (Ussher 1491–1451 BC)

Moses wrote down the stages of the journey at the command of the Lord (Numbers 33:2): forty-two stages in forty years, from Rameses in Egypt to the plains of Moab.

Rameses to Sinai		Exodus 12:37 – 19:2	The thirty-eight years, continued		Numbers 33:18–36
1	Rameses†	A 4	22	Makheleth†	H 6
	the Passover; set out in 1446 BC (Ussher 1491)		23	Tahath†	H 5
2	Succoth†	B 4	24	Terah†	H 5
3	Etham†	A 4	25	Mithkah†	H 5
	the pillar of cloud and fire (Exodus 13:20–22)		26	Hashmonah†	J 3
4	Pi Hahiroth†	B 4	27	Moseroth†	K 4
	through the midst of the sea (Exodus 14)		28	Bene Jaakan†	H 4
5	Marah†	D 8	29	Hor Hagidgad†	J 6
	the bitter water made sweet (Exodus 15:23–25)		30	Jotbathah†	J 8
6	Elim†	D 8	31	Abronah†	J 8
	twelve springs and seventy palm trees (15:27)		32	Ezion Geber†	J 8
7	by the Red Sea	not mapped			
8	Wilderness of Sin†	E 9			
	manna and quail (Exodus 16)				
9	Dophkah†	E 9			
10	Alush†	F 10			
11	Rephidim†	F 11			
	water from the rock; Amalek (Exodus 17)				
12	Wilderness of Sinai†	F 11			
	the covenant and the Law (Exodus 19 – Numbers 10)				
Sinai to Kadesh		Numbers 10:11 – 13:26			
13	Kibroth Hattaavah†	G 10			
	the graves of craving (Numbers 11:34)				
14	Hazeroth†	H 10			
	Miriam's leprosy (Numbers 12)				
The thirty-eight years		Numbers 33:18–36			
15	Rithmah†	G 9			
16	Rimmon Perez†	H 8			
17	Libnah†	J 7			
18	Rissah†	off the map			
19	Kehelathah†	H 6			
20	Mount Shepherd†	H 5			
21	Haradah†	H 5			

ON THIS MAP	
—>—	the journey, straight from stage to stage (the order, not the road)
•	a stage on the way, numbered as in Numbers 33
○	a stage of the thirty-eight years: places only, the way between them not known
⊙	stages at one site
•	another place named in the account
▲	another proposed site of Mount Sinai
Name†	a site in doubt: OpenBible.info rates it under 700 in 1,000 (35 of the 40 stages mapped); the scores are on page 2
—	perennial river
—	stream, in the rainy season
---	wadi, dry but after rain
■	sea or lake
■	marsh
—	contours, 500 m
▲ 1208 m • 635 m	summit; spot height, metres

THE GROUND			the Base Map's natural cover, modelled for c. 2000 BC; the Salt Sea over its southern basin		
■	forest and maquis	■	park forest of oak and carob	■	Christ-thorn
■	semi-steppe batha	■	juniper and evergreen oak	■	desert; acacia savannoid
■	sand; coastal sand, uncertain	■	reed, riverside thicket	■	oasis
■	Nile flood plain, flood basins	■	salt marsh and salt flat	■	lava field (basalt ground)
■	arid steppe of the plateaus	■	levee and riverside woodland	■	wet plain, papyrus swamp
■	fixed sand with wormwood	■	juniper woodland	■	high-mountain dwarf shrubland

Base Map of this project at 1:1,750,000 (relief and contours from the Copernicus GLO-30 DEM, European Space Agency 2021; its other sources on the second page). Sites: OpenBible.info Bible Geocoding data (CC BY 4.0). Names and verses: the New King James Version.

THE ROUTE OF THE EXODUS · THE STAGES

Numbers 33:1–49, with what happened at each stage, its site and OpenBible.info’s confidence in it

No.	Numbers 33	What happened there	Site (OpenBible.info)	Score	Square	Notes	
Rameses to Sinai Exodus 12:37 – 19:2							
1	Rameses 33:3, 5	set out the day after the Passover (Exodus 12:37)	Qantir	509‡	A 4	The stages are those of Numbers 33:1–49, in its order and with its names: forty-two, from Rameses, where the journey began, to the plains of Moab. The seventh, by the Red Sea (33:10), names no place and is not mapped.	
2	Succoth 33:5–6	the first camp (Exodus 12:37; 13:20)	Tell el Maskhuta	206‡	B 4		
3	Etham 33:6–7	at the edge of the wilderness; the pillar of cloud and fire (Exodus 13:20–22)	Tell er Retaba	72‡	A 4		
4	Pi Hahiroth 33:7–8	east of Baal Zephon, near Migdol; through the midst of the sea (Exodus 14)	Tell Defenneh	75‡	B 4		
5	Marah 33:8–9	three days in the Wilderness of Etham; the bitter water made sweet (Exodus 15:22–25)	Ain Hawarah	384‡	D 8		
6	Elim 33:9–10	twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees (Exodus 15:27)	Wadi Gharandal	533‡	D 8		
7	by the Red Sea 33:10–11	the place not given	no place named		not mapped		
8	Wilderness of Sin 33:11–12	manna and quail (Exodus 16)	Debbet er Ramleh	311‡	E 9		
9	Dophkah 33:12–13		Serabit el Khadim	441‡	E 9		
10	Alush 33:13–14		Wadi el Esh	302‡	F 10		
11	Rephidim 33:14–15	no water: water from the rock; Amalek (Exodus 17)	Wadi Rufaiyil	379‡	F 11	The sea: Exodus 14:2 sets the camp before Pi Hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, opposite Baal Zephon; OpenBible puts Pi Hahiroth and Baal Zephon both at Tell Defenneh. Where the sea was crossed is not known, and the line from Pi Hahiroth to Marah marks no crossing place. The isthmus is drawn as the Base Map models it for c. 2000 BC: Lake Timsah a marsh and seasonal lake, the Bitter Lakes a salt flat.	
12	Wilderness of Sinai 33:15–16	the covenant and the Law (Exodus 19 – Numbers 10)	Jebel Musa	465‡	F 11		
Sinai to Kadesh Numbers 10:11 – 13:26							
13	Kibroth Hattaavah 33:16–17	the graves of craving (Numbers 11:34)	Erweis el Ebeirig	405‡	G 10	Around Edom: Numbers 20:14–21 and 21:4 say that Edom refused the way through its land and that Israel went around it. OpenBible’s sites for Zalmonah, Punon and Oboth lie in and beside the Arabah, so the line crosses it twice; the sites set that course, not the text.	
14	Hazereth 33:17–18	Miriam struck with leprosy (Numbers 11:35 – 12:16)	Ain el Khadra	481‡	H 10		
The thirty-eight years Numbers 33:18–36							
15	Rithmah 33:18–19		Wadi Ratamah	235‡	G 9	The dates: 1 Kings 6:1 puts the Exodus 480 years before the fourth year of Solomon, 966 BC (the reckoning of the Kings chart, after Thiele): 1446 BC. Aaron died at Mount Hor in the fortieth year (Numbers 33:38), and Moses spoke to Israel in the plains of Moab in its eleventh month (Deuteronomy 1:3): 1406 BC. Ussher’s reckoning gives 1491 and 1451 BC.	
16	Rimmon Perez 33:19–20		Naqb al Biyar	144‡	H 8		
17	Libnah 33:20–21		Wadi el Beidha	129‡	J 7		
18	Rissah 33:21–22		Sharma	469‡	south of the map		
19	Kehelathah 33:22–23		Kuntillet Ajrud	80‡	H 6		
20	Mount Shepher 33:23–24		Wadi Lussan	172‡	H 5		
21	Haradah 33:24–25		Wadi Lussan	176‡	H 5		
22	Makheloth 33:25–26		Kuntillet Ajrud	145‡	H 6		
23	Tahath 33:26–27		Wadi Umm Hashim	91‡	H 5		
24	Terah 33:27–28		Wadi Umm Hashim	126‡	H 5		
25	Mithkah 33:28–29		Wadi Umm Hashim	126‡	H 5	The Salt Sea is drawn over its southern basin, as in the days of Moses and Joshua (all below 385 m below sea level in the basin, the Allotment Map’s rule), not at the Base Map’s 415 m of c. 2000 BC.	
26	Hashmonah 33:29–30		Tell es Saqati	71‡	J 3		
27	Moseroth 33:30–31	Moserah (Deuteronomy 10:6)	Har Zin	192‡	K 4		
28	Bene Jaakan 33:31–32		Birein	385‡	H 4		
29	Hor Hagidgad 33:32–33		Wadi Khadakhid	317‡	J 6		
30	Jotbathah 33:33–34	a land of rivers of water (Deuteronomy 10:7)	Taba	352‡	J 8		
31	Abronah 33:34–35		Aqaba	141‡	J 8		
32	Ezion Geber 33:35–36		Jezirat Faraun	360‡	J 8		
Kadesh to the plains of Moab Numbers 20 – 22:1							
33	Wilderness of Zin, which is Kadesh 33:36–37	the spies returned (Numbers 13:26); Miriam died; water from the rock (Numbers 20:1–13)	Ain el Qudeirat	864	H 5		The Bitter Lakes a salt flat (contested), Lake Timsah a marsh and a seasonal lake in the western Wadi Tumilat (Moshier and Hoffmeier 2015). The coast south-west of Tell el-Farama, before the Tineh plain formed (Stanley et al. 2008; Goodfriend and Stanley 1999); the Canopic promontory as marsh and lagoon (Flaux et al. 2017). The Ahramat Branch digitised from Ghoneim et al. 2024 (CC BY 4.0).
34	Mount Hor 33:37–41	Aaron died there, aged 123, in the fortieth year (33:38–39)	Har Zin	336‡	K 4		
35	Zalmonah 33:41–42	from Mount Hor around Edom; the bronze serpent, before Oboth (Numbers 21:4–10)	Wadi es Salmaneh	329‡	K 4		
36	Punon 33:42–43		Khirbet Faynan	755	L 5		
37	Oboth 33:43–44	camped after the bronze serpent (Numbers 21:10)	Ein Weibeh	361‡	K 5		
38	Ije Abarim 33:44–45	at the border of Moab (Numbers 21:11)	Medeineh	403‡	M 4		
39	Dibon Gad 33:45–46		Tall Dhiban	1000	M 2		
40	Almon Diblathaim 33:46–47		Duleilat esh Sharqiyeh	182‡	M 2		
41	the mountains of Abarim, before Nebo 33:47–48		the Abarim range (representative point)		L 1		
42	the plains of Moab 33:48–49	by the Jordan across from Jericho, from Beth Jesimoth to the Abel Acacia Grove; Balaam (Numbers 22–24)	Tell Azeimeh	799	L 1		
Other places on the map							
	Migdol 33:7; Exodus 14:2		Tell el Herr	236‡	C 3	NOTICES Scripture taken from the New King James Version®. Copyright © 1982 by Thomas Nelson. Used by permission. All rights reserved. Site positions adapted from the Bible Geocoding data at OpenBible.info (https://www.openbible.info/geo/), licensed under CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Uncertain identifications follow its best estimate. © DLR e.V. 2010–2014 and © Airbus Defence and Space GmbH 2014–2018 provided under COPERNICUS by the European Union and ESA; all rights reserved.	
	Baal Zephon 33:7; Exodus 14:2	with Pi Hahiroth (4)	Tell Defenneh	339‡	B 4		
	Arad 33:40; Numbers 21:1–3		Tel Arad	370‡	K 3		
	Hormah Numbers 14:45; 21:3		Tel Masos	449‡	J 3		
	Heshbon Numbers 21:25–30		Tell Hesban	433‡	M 1		
	Jahaz Numbers 21:23		Khirbet el Medeiyineh	444‡	M 2		
	Jericho 33:48, 50		Tell es Sultan	1000	L 1		
	Abel Acacia Grove 33:49		Tall el Hammam	511‡	L 1		
	Mount Nebo Deuteronomy 32:49; 34:1–5	the Base Map’s own name	Jabal al Naba	413‡	M 1		
	Mount Sinai Exodus 19:1–2, 18–20	with the Wilderness of Sinai (12)	Jebel Musa	465‡	F 11		
Other proposed sites of Mount Sinai (OpenBible.info), drawn faded							
	Har Karkom			103‡	J 6		
	Jebel Sin Bishar			89‡	D 7		
	Jebel Serbal			54‡	E 10		